

Glutaraldehyde



What is it?

Glutaraldehyde is a disinfectant. It is used mainly for cold sterilization of medical or dental instruments. It is sometimes present in creams, cleansers, skin medications, and injections. It also has industrial uses.

GLUTARALDEHYDE can also be known as:

- Glutaral
- Cidex

Less commonly:

- 1,3-diformyl propane
- 1,5-pentanedial
- Alhydex
- Dioxopentane
- Glutaric dialdehyde
- Pentanedial
- Sporicidin
- Ulcarcide

Some Possible Uses of GLUTARALDEHYDE /

Where it might be found:

- Facial cleanser (rare)
- Allergen extract
- Collagen extract
- Leather tanning (e.g. uppers chamois)
- X-ray & photo solution
- Photo gelatin hardener
- Electron microscopy product
- Water resistant wallpaper
- Used in the resin and dye industry
- Auto cooling system sealant
- Veterinary uses
- Embalming fluid

May be used to sterilize:

- Respiratory therapy supplies
- Scopes (i.e. bronchoscope, cystoscope, endoscope)
- ENT instruments
- Surgical instruments
- Dental instruments
- Home artificial kidney
- Dialysis unit forceps
- Anesthesia equipment
- Barber or hairdresser instruments

Other products that may cross-react with GLUTARALDEHYDE:

None

What should I do to avoid GLUTARALDEHYDE?

Avoid using any product that contains this allergen. Check the complete ingredient list on the label of each product you use. If no ingredient list is present, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's or store's website.

Tell your barber, hairdresser, doctor, nurse, or others involved in your care that you have this allergy.

To find a possible workplace exposure, check the Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS) as you are able. Check the ingredient labels of all items you encounter.

Glutaraldehyde



Glutaraldehyde will penetrate most types of rubber and vinyl gloves. Double gloving with nitrile gloves may give protection for up to one hour.

Choice of alternate methods for sterilization depends on tolerance of the item and whether you want to disinfect or sterilize. Steam autoclave works if the item is heat stable. Ethylene oxide may be used with some items, but it is flammable and toxic. Some instruments tolerate hydrogen peroxide gas plasma or peracetic acid vapor with gas plasma. Ortho - phthalaldehyde can cold sterilize, but it may stain skin or clothing.

Surfaces may be cleaned with:

- Benzalkonium chloride
- Ethanol
- Isopropyl alcohol
- Bleach products

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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